

official Fedora repository with no modifications. The Fedora Spins idea was widely popular, and over the last few releases after Fedora 7, Fedora has more than half a dozen spins at <http://spins.fedoraproject.org> that you can download and try. This includes Fedora Electronics Lab, Fedora Games Spin, Fedora LXDE, and many others. This was a grand success but there is more to it.

There were a lot of people interested in mixing third-party components or modifying existing Fedora packages in a way that met their needs, and to accommodate such interests, the project started discussing a secondary brand and I suggested the name, 'Fedora Remix', which was accepted by the project.

A Fedora Remix is a combination of Fedora software, with or without third-party software that any community member can create at any time. You can use a Fedora Remix to:

- Target a specific hardware platform like a netbook, router, or other device.
- Provide an appropriate combination of software for a specific interest group, like artists, musicians, software developers, educators, craftsmen, et al.
- Demonstrate a layered product using the Fedora platform as the underlying operating system.
- Build a portable, bootable environment for a classroom.
- Offer promotional material to customers inside a fully customisable OS.
- Or any one of countless other applications...

You can read more at <https://fedoraproject.org/wiki/Remix>

The next step: Omega

Omega (<http://omega.dgplug.org>) is my own project to create a Fedora Remix that integrates Fedora and a few popular and compatible third-party repositories for Fedora, including RPM Fusion, Livna and Adobe, and all the initial Fedora updates. The goal is to provide a

better out-of-the-box experience by integrating multimedia functionality from these popular third-party repositories and save bandwidth for users while providing a solid release. And all this, while being 100 per cent compatible with Fedora.

So not only do you get MP3, commercial DVDs, etc, working out-of-the-box, you also get the bug fixes and features introduced by Fedora post-release. The Omega (Boxer) release is a Fedora Remix derived from Fedora 12 and all the recent updates, and is included in the LFX DVD as an ISO image this month! It is a Live DVD and I encourage you to try it out.

One very common question I'm asked is, "How did you do this and how do I go about creating my own Fedora Remix?"

The process is very simple and this article is a quick introduction to it. Let me start with a basic introduction to the tools of the trade.

- **Anaconda:** This is the Fedora installer and during interactive mode, it asks a few questions. Anaconda creates a file by default called *anaconda-ks.cfg* in the */root/* of every Fedora installation saving the input from the user and has a record of details such as the language, time zone, packages selected, etc, that enables the user to create a perfect replica of the same set-up across as many systems as the user wants. This is called a kickstart file. It basically provides the answers to the questions that Anaconda asks, and it is very powerful and flexible. Fedora provides the tools to create a Fedora Spin or Fedora Remix and with these tools, you can create images based on your preferences using the same kickstart files.
- **Pungi:** As part of the Fedora 7 release, Fedora's primary release engineer, Jesse Keating, wrote Pungi to create the official Fedora installation images (CD set and DVD). Pungi is available in the Fedora repository itself, including



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